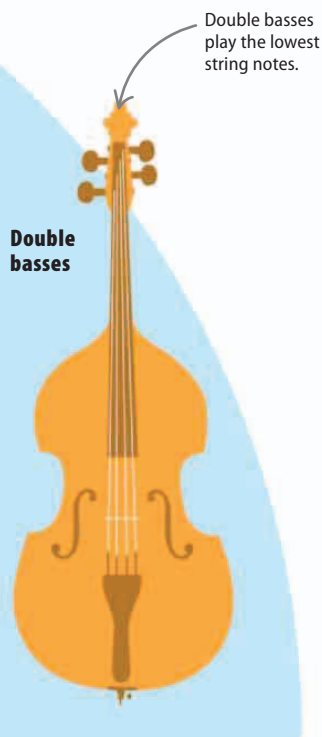


History of the orchestra

The earliest orchestra, established by French composer Lully in 1626, consisted of five sizes of violin-type instruments. During the Baroque era, flutes, oboes, bassoons, horns, trumpets, and drums were added to the basic string ensemble. In the Classical era, clarinets and trombones appeared regularly, joined by the tuba and various percussion instruments in the Romantic period, until the modern symphony orchestra was finally established by around 1900.



Lully 1626	Baroque	Classical	Romantic	From 1900
24 violins of five different sizes	2 first violins 2 second violins	4 first violins 4 second violins	8 first violins 8 second violins	12 first violins 12 second violins
	2 violas	4 violas	8 violas	10 violas
	1 cello	2 cellos	6 cellos	8 cellos
		1 double bass	4 double basses	6 double basses
	harpsichord			piano
				synthesizer
	2 recorders	2 flutes	2 flutes 1 piccolo	3 flutes 1 piccolo
	2 oboes	2 oboes	2 oboes 1 cor anglais	3 oboes 1 cor anglais
		2 clarinets	2 clarinets 1 E flat (small) 1 bass (large)	3 clarinets 1 E flat (small) 1 bass (large)
				1 alto sax
	1 bassoon	2 bassoons	2 bassoons 1 contrabassoon	3 bassoons 1 contrabassoon
	2 timpani	2 timpani	3 timpani	5 timpani
			side drum bass drum triangle celeste xylophone tubular bells cymbals	side drum bass drum triangle celeste xylophone tubular bells cymbals vibraphone marimba tambourine
		2 French horns	4 French horns	4 French horns
	2 trumpets	2 trumpets	4 trumpets	4 trumpets
			3 trombones (2 tenor, 1 bass)	3 trombones (2 tenor, 1 bass)
				1 tuba

△ Growth of the orchestra

The orchestra has grown in size from a small court ensemble to a massive—and expensive—musical entity, which sounds its best in a large concert hall or first-class recording studio.